

The Life and Legacy of St. Luke the Apostle

By Dn Yonnas · Saints · Youth & Young Adults

Summary

St. Luke — the beloved physician, evangelist, companion of St. Paul, and according to tradition the first iconographer. The lesson surveys his Gospel's unique parables and miracles, his authorship of Acts, and his martyrdom under Nero after a life poured out in preaching.

Lesson Objectives

- Know who St. Luke was: Gentile convert, physician, evangelist, historian
- Identify what is unique to the Gospel of Luke
- Tell how his witness continued through Acts and unto martyrdom

Key Bible Verses

Colossians 4:14 — "Luke the beloved physician"

Luke 1:3 — "it seemed good to me also... to write to you an orderly account"

Luke 15 — the parables of the lost sheep, the lost coin, and the prodigal son

Main Teaching Points

- Not one of the Twelve, yet a tireless apostle and the historian of the early Church
- His Gospel traces Christ's lineage back to Adam — salvation for all humanity
- Only Luke records the widow of Nain, the Prodigal Son, and the Good Samaritan
- He gives the most detailed account of the Nativity and of St. Mary's song
- Acts is his second volume — the Spirit's work through the apostles
- He continued preaching in Rome after Sts. Peter and Paul were martyred, until his own martyrdom

Key Terms

- **Evangelist** — A writer of one of the four Holy Gospels.
- **The Seventy-Two** — The wider circle of disciples sent by the Lord (Luke 10); tradition counts St. Luke among them.
- **Iconographer** — A painter of holy icons; tradition remembers St. Luke as the first, painting the Theotokos.

Discussion & Reflection

- What does St. Luke's careful research teach us about faith and truth?
- Why do the 'mercy parables' appear only in Luke — what does that show about his heart?
- How can your profession, like Luke's medicine, serve the Gospel?